

Telecom Industry has Immense Employment Potential

Currently, India has over 900 million mobile subscribers, and the figure is expected to reach one billion mark by 2014. India also has the second largest telecommunication network in the world. With introduction of newer technologies, there is a plethora of new job opportunities in the hardware as well as the software domain of telecommunication

ABHISHEK MUTHA

What's the current telecom industry scenario in India? "Telecom industry is not as rosy as it should be," answers Janardan Revuru, project manager, Hewlett Packard. He believes, "India has no dearth of technological and business innovation, but the telecom policies and scams have caused a negative impact on the sector, which has forced the service providers to rethink about their investments."

In the wake of the famous 2G spectrum scam of 2011—considered as one of the biggest abuses of power—most of the companies were trimming their workforce back then. However, it was believed that job opportunities would surge again, once everything was stabilised. But the last few years have not been great for our engineering graduates.

"We are still dependent on MNCs to outsource work to India for creating jobs here," explains Revuru.

On a positive note, "There is immense potential and fierce competition." That's how Haziq Khan, vice-president, sales and marketing, Netxcell Limited, defines the Indian telecommunications industry today. He adds, "In spite of all the challenges, the industry is bound to grow further in the time to come. We have already witnessed exponential growth in tele-density in urban areas and slow but steady growth have been seen in rural areas too."

As on September 30, 2012, the total number of telecom subscribers was



around 937 million, out of which 96.7 per cent are wireless subscribers and the remaining are wireline subscribers, according to a TRAI report.

"The industry has seen humongous growth with voice services and now it is time to move further with data services. That's what makes